

NF Limiter — Complete User Manual

TRUE PEAK MASTERING LIMITER

Quick workflow

1. Insert NF Limiter in the last slot of the master bus.
2. Keep True Peak on and start with Ceiling at -1.0 dBTP for streaming targets.
3. Raise Gain while watching the central Gain Reduction meter.
4. Choose Clean for transparency, Punch for transient impact, or Loud for density.
5. Compare against Bypass at a matched perceived level.
6. Use Delta / Listen to hear exactly what the limiter is changing, if you want to check your settings by ear.

Controls

GAIN

Input gain applied before limiting, -12 to $+24$ dB. Drives how much the limiter has to work.

CEILING

The true-peak output ceiling, -12 to -0.1 dBTP. The final output never exceeds this value while True Peak is on.

RELEASE / AUTO

Release sets how fast gain reduction recovers, 10–1000 ms. AUTO automatically scales that speed to the intensity and duration of the peaks it just caught.

TRUE PEAK

Detects true (reconstructed, inter-sample) peaks rather than sample peaks only, so material that would clip on conversion to analogue or on lossy encoding stays under the Ceiling.

CHARACTER — Clean / Punch / Loud

Clean is bit-transparent, with no added colouration. **Punch** uses a faster adaptive release to keep transients snappy. **Loud** adds a gentle, controlled saturation density on limited peaks.

DELTA / LISTEN

A monitoring-only control: engage it to hear exactly what the limiter is removing or changing — gain reduction, Character's colouration, and anything shaped by the Ceiling — instead of the normal output. It never alters what is actually sent to the host when off, is never saved in a preset or session, always starts off on a fresh session or preset load, and is cancelled automatically while Bypass is engaged.

STEREO LINK

At 100%, both channels always receive the same gain reduction, keeping the stereo image perfectly stable. Lower values let the channels react more independently to their own peaks.

BYPASS

The purple power button compares the processed signal against the original through the exact same audio path — latency-compensated, click-free. Lit means the limiter is active; dark means bypassed.

Automatic True Peak precision. NF Limiter no longer has a user-facing OVERSAMPLING control. The internal processing and True-Peak-detection precision are chosen automatically from your project's sample rate — full precision at 44.1/48 kHz, and proportionally lighter (but still fully validated) at higher sample rates, where the extra headroom above the audible band needs less oversampling to reconstruct true peaks accurately. This means: no CPU/quality trade-off to manage, no click or gap from switching factors, and the plugin's reported latency never changes during a session — including when the sample rate changes.

Meters

INPUT and OUTPUT show the L/R channels in real time. GAIN REDUCTION shows the attenuation applied right now and its recent history. PEAK and TRUE PEAK show the highest values reached since the plugin opened or the last reset. LUFS-M is momentary loudness; LUFS-I accumulates since the plugin opened or the last reset (menu → Reset LUFS). TRUE PEAK OVER is a passive indicator: it lights briefly whenever the post-limiter output exceeds the Ceiling by more than 0.05 dB.

Presets and menu

Choose a preset from the top bar, or click SAVE to name and store the current settings as a new user preset. The A/B slots let you compare two variations; COPY duplicates the current slot's settings into the other. The three-line menu opens this manual, the presets folder, About, and Reset Window Size. Drag the lower-right handle to resize the window; click the NF logo to restore the default size.